Case 1 - Franchise Partner Acquisition, Geo-Selection & Onboarding Engine

A fast-growing retail brand wants to open many more franchise stores, but the journey from a partner's first application to an open, trained store is slow and leaky.

Build a solution that takes this journey off the expansion team's plate.

Reference companies - look these up to get a feel for the problem:

- **Lenskart** - eyewear brand that grows through franchise-owned stores
- **Delhivery** - logistics company whose last-mile network includes franchise-run delivery centres
- **Amazon (I Have Space)** - partners with local shop owners to handle deliveries and pickups

Key terms

- **Franchisor / franchisee** - the brand, and the local partner who invests in and runs a store under it
- **Catchment** - the area around a store that its customers come from
- **Cannibalisation** - a new store taking sales from an existing store of the same brand nearby
- **Payback period** - how long a partner takes to earn back their investment
- **Onboarding** - everything between a partner being accepted and their store opening

Primer reading: the International Franchise Association's overview of how franchising works (https://www.franchise.org/franchising-overview/).

Test data format

Judges will upload an Excel file in exactly this structure (template: *Case1_Franchise_Test_Data_Format.xlsx*). Judges will upload Sheets 1 and 2; Sheet 3 (existing stores) is fixed and already filled in. Your solution must accept it as-is.

Not sure what a column means? The template has a **Glossary** sheet explaining every column that is not self-explanatory.

Allowed values - test data will only use the values below, so you do not need to handle anything else.

City	State	Pin codes start with	City tier
Bengaluru	Karnataka	560	Tier 1
Mysuru	Karnataka	570	Tier 2
Mangaluru	Karnataka	575	Tier 2
Hubballi-Dharwad	Karnataka	580	Tier 2
Belagavi	Karnataka	590	Tier 2

City	State	Pin codes start with	City tier
Tumakuru	Karnataka	572	Tier 3
Davanagere	Karnataka	577	Tier 3

Preferred language: Kannada, English or Hindi.

How to read the tables below: judges fill in every column in Sheets 1 and 2 - your solution only reads them and never has to create them. Sheet 3 is fixed and already filled in. **Fixed list** columns only use the values shown. **Any text** columns can contain anything the applicant wrote, including messy or incomplete answers. **ID** columns are just reference labels.

Sheet 1 - Applications (one row per applicant)

Column	What it means	Format	Example
Application ID	Reference label for each application	ID	APP-001
Applicant name	Name of the person applying	Any text	Ravi Kumar
City · State · Pin code	Where the applicant wants to open the store	Fixed list (see Allowed values) · 6-digit pin code	Mysuru · Karnataka · 570001
Investment capacity (₹ lakh)	Money the applicant can put into the store; 1 lakh = ₹1,00,000	Number	25
Retail experience (years)	Years spent running or managing any shop	Number, 0 if none	4
Current / past business	What the applicant does or did, in their own words	Any text	Runs a footwear store
Space available	Whether the applicant already has a shop space	Fixed list: Owned / Rented / Not yet identified	Rented
Space size (sq ft)	Size of that space	Number, blank if no space	450
Floor	Where the space is	Fixed list: Ground / Upper / Mall unit / Not known	Ground
Target launch (months)	How many months from now the applicant wants to open	Number	3

Column	What it means	Format	Example
Preferred language	Language the applicant wants training in	Fixed list: Kannada / English / Hindi	Kannada
Notes from applicant	Anything else the applicant wrote	Any text	Wants to open before Diwali

Sheet 2 - Territories (one row per territory)

Column	What it means	Format	Example
Territory ID	A label the brand gives each area it wants to grow in. Applications do not carry this ID; link applicants to territories by pin code.	ID	TER-01
City · State	City the territory is in	Fixed list (see Allowed values)	Mysuru · Karnataka
Pin codes covered	Pin codes that fall inside this territory	6-digit pin codes, comma-separated	570001, 570002, 570008
City tier	Size of the city, as in Allowed values	Fixed list: Tier 1 / Tier 2 / Tier 3	Tier 2
Open slots	How many more stores the brand wants to open here	Number	3
Priority	How keen the brand is to grow here right now	Fixed list: High / Medium / Low	High

Sheet 3 - Existing stores (fixed - already filled in the template; these are all the brand's stores open today)

Store ID	City	Pin code	Opened (year)
ST-01	Bengaluru	560001	2019
ST-02	Bengaluru	560034	2020
ST-03	Bengaluru	560038	2021
ST-04	Bengaluru	560066	2022
ST-05	Bengaluru	560076	2023
ST-06	Mysuru	570009	2021

Store ID	City	Pin code	Opened (year)
ST-07	Mysuru	570017	2024
ST-08	Mangaluru	575001	2022
ST-09	Hubballi-Dharwad	580020	2023
ST-10	Belagavi	590001	2024

How we will test your MVP link

Testing happens in two parts.

Part 1 - File upload

- We will upload our own Applications and Territories sheets in the format above.
- Some applications will be incomplete or contradictory, and several will compete for the same territory.
- The brand never opens two stores in the same pin code. Your solution must respect this rule.

Part 2 - Follow-up questions

- After processing the file, we will ask your solution about its decisions in plain language - for example, "Why is APP-007 on hold?"
- We will also give it new information - for example, "APP-012 has now found a ground-floor space" - and check that its decision changes sensibly.

For every application, from either part

- We expect to see what should happen to that partner and why.
- For partners who move forward, we expect to see what they need to do next and how they will be prepared to run the store.
- We judge your reasoning and how clearly your solution explains its decisions - there is no single right answer.
- The link must work for us without your help or a login.